



House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 10

February Session, 2026

Substitute House Bill No. 5150

House of Representatives, March 11, 2026

The Committee on Education reported through REP. LEEPER of the 132nd Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING AUTHORIZATION OF STATE GRANT COMMITMENTS FOR SCHOOL BUILDING PROJECTS AND REVISIONS TO THE SCHOOL BUILDING PROJECT STATUTES.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. (*Effective from passage*) The Commissioner of Administrative
2 Services, having reviewed applications for state grants for public school
3 building projects in accordance with section 10-283 of the general
4 statutes on the basis of priorities for such projects and standards for
5 school construction established by the State Board of Education, and
6 having prepared a listing of all such eligible projects ranked in order of
7 priority, as determined by said commissioner together with the amount
8 of the estimated grant with respect to each eligible project, and having
9 submitted such listing of eligible projects, prior to December 15, 2025, to
10 a committee of the General Assembly established under section 10-283a
11 of the general statutes for the purpose of reviewing such listing, is
12 hereby authorized to enter into grant commitments on behalf of the state
13 in accordance with said section 10-283a with respect to the priority
14 listing of such projects and in such estimated amounts as approved by

15 said committee prior to February 1, 2026, as follows:

T1	School District	Estimated	Estimated
T2	School	Project Costs	Grant
T3	Project Number		
T4			
T5	MILFORD		
T6	Jonathan Law High School		
T7	084-0217 EA	\$12,650,000	\$4,968,920
T8			
T9	NORWICH		
T10	Teachers' Memorial Global Studies		
T11	Magnet Middle School		
T12	104-0122 N	\$69,367,713	\$55,494,170
T13			
T14	SEYMOUR		
T15	Bungay Elementary School		
T16	124-0058 N	\$60,000,000	\$38,748,000
T17			
T18	STAMFORD		
T19	Julia Stark Elementary School		
T20	135-0294 A/EC	\$14,347,081	\$8,608,249
T21			
T22	WATERBURY		
T23	Roberto Clemente International Dual		
T24	Language School		
T25	151-0318 EA	\$38,755,850	\$30,589,992
T26			
T27	WESTPORT		
T28	Long Lots Elementary School		
T29	158-0101 N	\$110,472,124	\$12,229,264

16 Sec. 2. Section 10-285a of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes
 17 is amended by adding subsection (m) as follows (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

18 (NEW) (m) On and after July 1, 2026, if the student enrollment of a
 19 school district has increased by twenty per cent or more over the ten-
 20 year period immediately preceding the date an application is submitted
 21 pursuant to section 10-283, the reimbursement percentage of the town
 22 of such school district shall be increased by twenty percentage points,

- 23 provided such increase shall not result in a reimbursement percentage
24 exceeding one hundred per cent.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section
Sec. 2	<i>July 1, 2026</i>	10-285a(m)

Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section
Sec. 2	<i>July 1, 2026</i>	10-285a(m)

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Section 2, "of the 2026 supplement" was added in the leading language for consistency with standard drafting conventions.

ED *Joint Favorable Subst. -LCO*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Treasurer, Debt Serv.	GF - Future Cost	See Below	See Below

Note: GF=General Fund

Municipal Impact:

Municipalities	Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Various Municipalities	Future Revenue Gain	See Below	See Below

Explanation

The bill approves a net increase of \$151 million in state grant commitments for school construction projects, which represents potential revenue gain for the specified municipalities. The grants-in-aid will be financed through the issuance of General Obligation (GO) bonds in future fiscal years. The bill does not authorize new GO bonds. The projected debt service cost to the General Fund to issue \$151 million of GO bonds at current market rates is \$230 million over 20 years.

The bill also increases the reimbursement rate by 20 percentage points for school construction projects in districts where student enrollment has increased by 20 percent or more over the ten years prior to project application. To the extent future projects are found to be eligible for the reimbursement increase and relevant projects are proposed, approved, and completed, there would be increased costs to the state and increased revenue to involved municipalities. The impact of the increased reimbursements for future projects on the school

construction priority list will be reflected when such projects are considered by the legislature in the future.

The Out Years

The ongoing fiscal impact identified above will continue into the future subject to project completion, successful application for reimbursement, and the costs of borrowing.

OLR Bill Analysis**sHB 5150*****AN ACT CONCERNING AUTHORIZATION OF STATE GRANT COMMITMENTS FOR SCHOOL BUILDING PROJECTS AND REVISIONS TO THE SCHOOL BUILDING PROJECT STATUTES.*****SUMMARY**

This bill authorizes school construction state grant commitments totaling \$150.6 million toward total estimated project costs of \$305.6 million.

The bill also establishes a new 20-percentage-point bonus reimbursement rate for municipalities where the school district has experienced an enrollment increase of 20% or more over the 10-year period immediately before a district's school construction application. It specifies that this bonus rate cannot put a project's total reimbursement rate over 100%.

EFFECTIVE DATE: Upon passage, except the bonus rate provision is effective July 1, 2026.

PRIORITY LIST GRANT COMMITMENTS

Under the state school construction grant program, the state reimburses towns and local districts for a percentage of eligible school construction costs through state general obligation bonds (with less wealthy municipalities getting a higher reimbursement). The municipalities pay the remaining costs.

The bill authorizes school construction state grant commitments totaling \$150.6 million toward total estimated project costs of \$305.6 million. For each project the bill authorizes, the table below shows the district, school, project type, estimates for total cost and state grant commitment, and state reimbursement rate.

Table: 2026 School Construction Grant Commitments

<i>District</i>	<i>School</i>	<i>Project Type</i>	<i>Estimated Project Cost</i>	<i>Estimated Grant</i>	<i>Reimbursement Rate</i>
Milford	Jonathan Law High School	Extension/ Alteration	\$12,650,000	\$4,968,920	39.28%
Norwich	Teachers' Memorial Global Studies Magnet Middle School	New Construction	69,367,713	55,494,170	80.00%
Seymour	Bungay Middle School	New Construction	60,000,000	38,748,000	64.58%
Stamford	Julia Stark Elementary School	Alteration/ Energy Conservation	14,347,081	8,608,249	60.00%
Waterbury	Roberto Clemente International Dual Language School	Extension/ Alteration	38,755,850	30,589,992	78.93%
Westport	Long Lots Elementary School	New Construction	110,472,124	12,229,264	11.07%
Totals			305,592,768	150,638,595	

COMMITTEE ACTION

Education Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 44 Nay 1 (02/27/2026)